

2025年8月9日大陆雅思纸笔考试听力(机经原题)

Part 4

Part 4, you will hear a lecture about reintroducing the beaver population to Britain. First you have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Now listen carefully and answer questions 31 to 40.

Good afternoon everyone. Today's lecture focuses on an ambitious ecological project - the reintroduction of beavers to the British Isles. For centuries, beavers were widespread across Britain's rivers and wetlands. However, due to extensive hunting, they gradually disappeared.

They were mainly trapped for their thick fur, which was highly valued in clothing production. As well as for their meat. But another major reason for their decline was the demand for a certain grandeur secretion they produced. This substance played a key role in (31) **transport**.

Today, conservationists are leading efforts to reintroduce beavers into carefully selected habitats. However, one of the major challenges is ensuring that these animals are not targeted by illegal activities again. Experts agree that (32) **protection** is absolutely essential to prevent illegal hunting.

Moving on to biological characteristics, researchers have identified key differences between North American and Eurasian beaver species. One of the most noticeable distinctions can be observed in the physical structure of the (33) **tail**. The shape varies considerably between the two, with one being significantly broader and more paddle-like than the other.

When examining behavioral patterns, beavers demonstrate fascinating movement habits within river systems. Studies show beavers travel through waterways in repeated ways yearly. This matches the (34) **migration** of salmon - moving between rivers and seas annually. Beavers display comparable behavior, using identical paths during specific periods, particularly when weather shifts.

Historically, humans have utilized beaver secretions in surprising ways. The oil from their castor glands, valued for its distinctive musky aroma, became an important ingredient in (35) **perfumes**, which have long-lasting quality. In fact, this natural fixative was so effective that it remained a staple in luxury production well into the early 20th century before synthetic alternatives became available.

However, not everyone welcomes the beavers' return. Some community members have expressed concerns that the dams constructed by beavers may lead to various problems, including potential (36) **headaches** for local residents, particularly in agricultural areas.

On the positive side, the presence of beavers has brought numerous benefits. For example, areas with

established beaver populations have increased the revenue of (37) **tourism**, as nature enthusiasts flock to observe these fascinating creatures in their natural habitat.

From an environmental perspective, beaver dams reduce risks during heavy rainfall, effectively preventing sudden (38) **flood**. These natural barriers effectively slow down rushing water, allowing it to gradually absorb into the soil.

In addition, the ponds created by their dam-building activities serve as natural filtration systems, effectively reducing harmful (39) **nitrogen** in the water - a significant benefit for local ecosystems. This natural purification process helps prevent algal blooms and maintains balanced aquatic habitats for wildlife.

Perhaps most importantly, these engineered wetlands create thriving habitats that support increased biodiversity, providing ideal conditions not just for fish and birds, but also for numerous species of (40) **insects** that form the foundation of the food chain.

So, their successful reintroduction demonstrates how restoring native species can help address contemporary environmental challenges, from biodiversity loss to climate change adaptation.

That's the end of Part 4. You now have half a minute to check your answers to Part4.

2025年7月26日大陆雅思纸笔考试听力(机经原题)

Part 4

Part 4, you will hear a lecture on why living in cities might be better for the environment than living in rural areas. First you have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Now listen carefully and answer questions 31 to 40.

Good morning everyone. Today we're going to look at urban migration – that is, people moving from outside cities to inside them. I think it's easy to jump to the conclusion that a rural lifestyle is greener. However, recent studies suggest this isn't actually the case.

First, if we look at the planet's land area, cities occupy only 3%. And it's these cities that actually release 30% to 40% of the (31) **carbon** into the atmosphere. This is lower than the 60% to 70% coming from non-urban areas.

So, let's imagine the impact if most people decided to move to cities.

One advantage would be that this movement of people out of the countryside and into cities should reduce the pressure on the land from intensive farming. This would allow certain (32) **forests** to regenerate.

Another point in favour of urban migration is that services are much more energy efficient if they are concentrated in cities. For example, this is true for electricity, and you can imagine, for water as well.

Then, once you remember that rural communities are often very spread out, you can see another environmental benefit for living in the city. Rural residents rely far more on cars than city dwellers, who can use other eco-friendly (33) **transport**, like buses and trains. And their journeys also tend to be shorter.

Another point supporting urban migration is that certain recycling schemes are only feasible where populations are concentrated. Take Seattle in the USA as an example, where methane gas is being put to good use to generate power for the city. This methane gas comes from the city's (34) **rubbish**, something that couldn't be collected so efficiently in rural areas.

Now, another factor threatening the environment is the growing world population. It's estimated that 75 million babies are born each year now, and in some countries, the birth rate shows no signs of slowing down. Urban migration might provide an answer to this. In cities, one reason women have fewer children is that they marry later and start a family much later. And the reason for this is that it's much easier to find work in the city, and once you have a job, you're more easily to get (35) **promotion**.

Well, it would be foolish to pretend there are no downsides to city life, because clearly there are. One point critics often make is that migrants might end up losing their (36) **culture**, although some research has found the opposite happens. Far from abandoning their traditions, people work to maintain them.

A more obvious fact is that we see more (37) **crime** happening in cities compared to the lower rates of that observed in rural areas. I'm afraid not many of you here today could say you haven't been affected by it, directly or indirectly.

There's also an issue we have to deal with. Many cities, including our own, now suffer from such high levels of pollution that the (38) **air** we breathe is far from pure.

Another factor arguing against the idea that cities are greener is that urbanization tends to boost a country's economy. Put simply, when a population's (39) **wealth** improves, energy consumption also rises.

One direct consequence of a stronger economy, which many citizens now experience every day and may feel the pressure, is the volume of (40) **traffic** on the roads, despite the other transport options we mentioned earlier.

This is a problem that won't disappear anytime soon, although there are solutions that could be considered. Let's look at some of those plans...

That's the end of Part 4. You now have half a minute to check your answers to Part 4.

2025年7月19日大陆雅思纸笔考试听力(机经原题)

Part 4

Part 4, you will hear a lecture about the history of bags and purses. First you have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Now listen carefully and answer questions 31 to 40.

Lecturer: Good afternoon. Today, we're going to trace the fascinating evolution of an everyday item: the bag or purse. It's an object with a surprisingly long and varied history, reflecting changes in society, fashion, and technology.

Our story begins a very long time ago. Dating back to around 2500 BC, the oldest bag we have actual evidence for, preserved remarkably well, comes from ancient Egypt. Imagine that! So, bags have been essential companions for millennia.

Moving forward to the medieval period, specifically the 14th and 15th centuries, we see an interesting trend concerning men. Back then, men typically used pouches – mainly to hold their (31) **coins**. Money wasn't carried loose in pockets as often back then.

Now, let's jump to the 18th and 19th centuries. This period saw bags and purses becoming more elaborate and symbolic. Take priests, for instance – their ornate purses served more than a practical purpose; they were deliberately selected to signify the priest's (32) **status** in society.

For fashionable women, delicate bags made of silk became popular. Unlike today's spacious handbags, these petite accessories were typically attached to (33) **belts** - either lightly secured or firmly fastened.

To protect their valuables within domestic spaces, women of this era developed careful storage practices. Their precious bags - often containing personal items or small treasures - were routinely concealed in the most private area of the bedroom. For safekeeping, especially in the home, women frequently stored their bags out of sight, hidden discreetly beneath their (34) **marriage** beds. The practice of storing bags in this intimate space demonstrates how women creatively adapted their living environment for both security and personal privacy.

Going back slightly earlier, to the broader medieval age, pouches were very common, becoming an essential part of daily attire. Pouches were fundamentally linked to (35) **skirts** during this era. However, living conditions during this period presented some challenges. Frankly speaking, hygiene standards left much to be desired, creating rather unpleasant odors in daily life. To address this issue, people came up with a practical solution: they would routinely fill their pouches with sweet (36) **spices**. This clever practice served multiple purposes - not only did it mask unwanted smells from the pouch's contents or the wearer's body, but it also helped purify the general environment around them.

Besides carrying personal items, small purses served another important purpose: they were commonly used to present (37) **gifts**. Items like money, sweet-smelling perfumes, or perhaps a precious trinket would

be presented in a decorative purse.

Finally, we reach the modern era, spanning roughly the 1930s to the 1960s. This was a time of significant innovation. New, exciting materials became available for bag making. New fabrics like plastic - offered bright colours and easy cleaning, while the invention of (38) **zippers** revolutionised fastenings, making bags much more secure and convenient than ties or clasps.

Leather bags also evolved dramatically. Their design and marketing began to appeal strongly to women, reflecting the growing sense of (39) **feminism** of the period.

Furthermore, lifestyles were changing. People became more active, participating in leisure activities like tennis or picnics. This created a demand for specialised bags. Consequently, bags designed specifically for (40) **sports** became incredibly popular, almost as essential as the right pair of shoes for the activity. They were practical, sturdy, and designed for purpose.

So, from ancient Egyptian relics to the sporty bags of the 1960s, the humble bag has constantly adapted, telling us a great deal about how people lived, worked, and played throughout history...

That's the end of Part 4. You now have half a minute to check your answers.